

CLEAR?

Question?

SPM 381 · CONSUMER BEHAVIOR IN SPORT

Consumer Decision-Making in Sport

How consumers choose — and how sport fans decide differently

ARCADIA UNIVERSITY SPORT MANAGEMENT · WEEK 4 · FALL 2026

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FRAMING THE TOPIC

What Is Decision-Making?

What is decision making?

What is consumer decision making?

Why do we study the decision-making process?

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A WORKING DEFINITION

Decision-Making

*Decision making **is the study of identifying and choosing alternatives based on the values and preferences of the decision maker.** Making a decision implies that there are alternative choices to be considered, and in such a case we want not only to identify as many of these alternatives as possible but to choose the one that best fits with our goals, objectives, desires, values, and so on*

Source – Harris (1980)

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APPLYING THE CONCEPT

Consumer Decision-Making

Covers critical thinking skills related to consumers' goals, needs, wants and the effects of attitudes, advertising, information and opportunity costs on consumer behavior.

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CONSUMER DECISION-MAKING, CONT.

Behavioral Decision Theory

One of the most active academic research spheres in marketing over the past decades has been behavioral decision theory.

Behavioral decision theorists have identified many situations in which consumers make irrational choices.

Understanding how these effects manifest in the marketplace can be crucial for marketers.

The work of these and other scholars have also challenged predictions from economic theory and assumptions about rationality, leading to the appearance of the field of behavioral economics.

See Table 1 (p.8) in Stankevich (2017) - one of this week's readings.

The key models are shortly presented starting from 1960 till nowadays.

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CONSUMER DECISION-MAKING, CONT.

A Working Definition

The thought process of selecting a logical choice from the available options.



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EXTENDING THE CONCEPT

Sport Consumer Decision-Making

Consumer Decision-Making vs. Sport Consumer Decision-Making

Any difference?



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REFLECT & DISCUSS

Think About...

Can you describe what sports or sporting event is important to you and when the activity takes on greater significance in your life?

Can you describe why it is so important and how did it become so meaningful?

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PROBLEMS

Problems

The challenge for sport professionals and researchers is to identify key elements of the decision-making process that influence behavior.

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THIS WEEK'S READING SCENARIOS

Scenarios

01 **FRET AND REGRET**
A Consumer Decision-Making Dilemma

02 **MILE HIGH MAGIC**
Maximizing the Broncos Experience

Source – Please read these two articles and respond to this week's discussion questions.

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SPORT CONSUMER DECISION-MAKING, CONT.

What Drives Game Attendance?

What are important key elements of the decision-making process that influence sport consumers' game attendance?

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SPORT CONSUMER DECISION-MAKING, CONT.

Scenario: Super Bowl 60

Assume that you attended the Super Bowl 60, which was held at Levi's Stadium in Santa Clara.

Identify any reasons or factors that influence your Super Bowl attendance...(please list as many as possible).

Please provide the decision-making process.

All answers are needed to report in this week's discussion questions. See the questions 5 & 6



Super Bowl LX, Levi's Stadium, Santa Clara, CA (Feb. 8, 2026) · Photo: MMG, CC BY 4.0

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SPORT CONSUMER DECISION-MAKING, CONT.

Motivation, SportWay & Sport Decision-Making

Sport decision-making sequence → SportWay seeking sport experiences

Shown here as an example of a confusing model — too many intermediate steps between motivation and actual behavior.

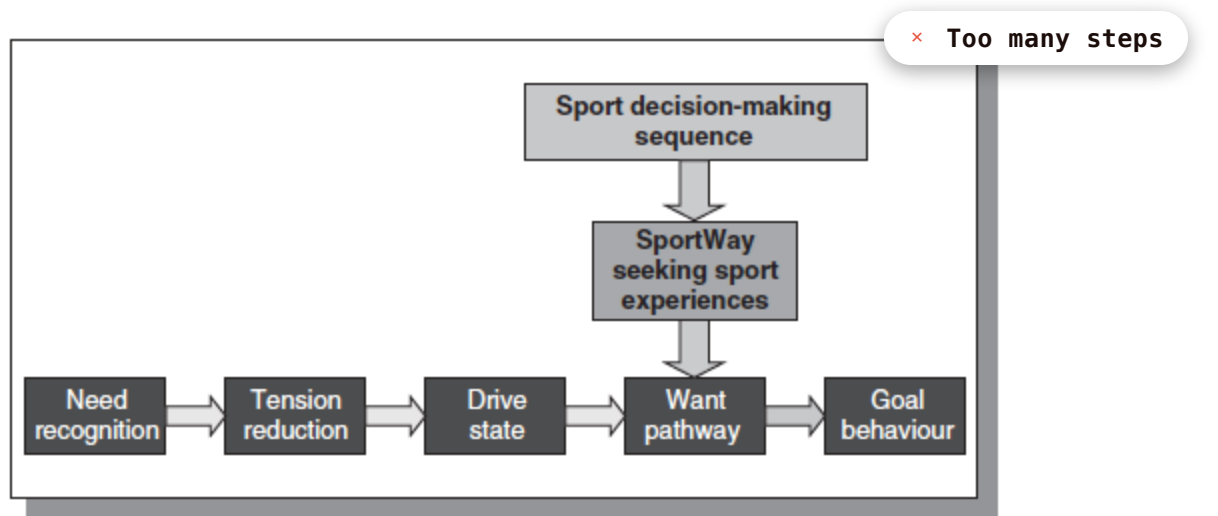


Figure 3.1
Motivation, SportWay and Sport Decision-Making.

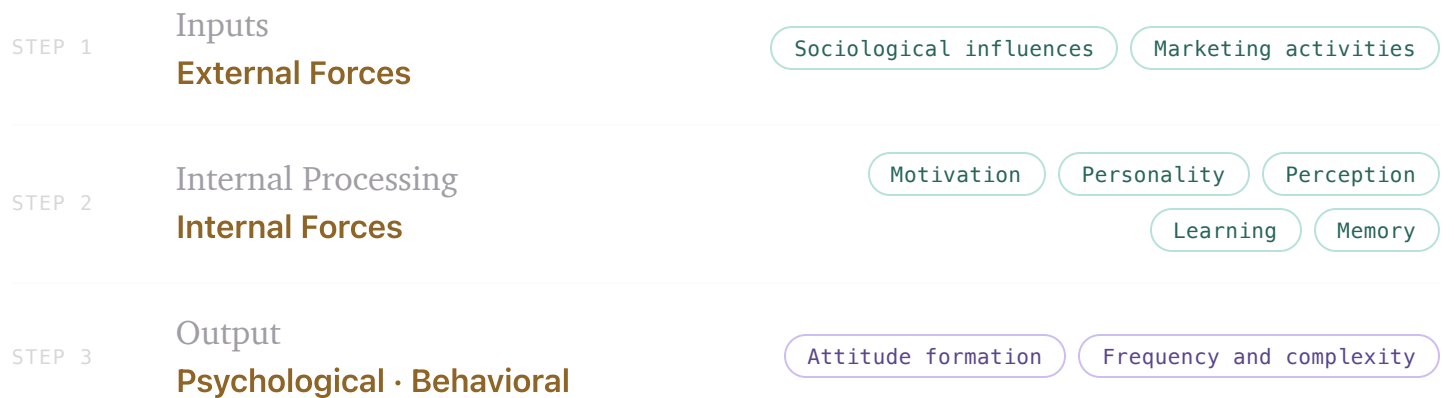
Funk (2008, p. 30), Figure 3.1 – Motivation, SportWay and Sport Decision-Making

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SPORT CONSUMER DECISION-MAKING, CONT.

The Sport Decision-Making Sequence



Source – Funk (2008, p. 31) · Sport Decision Making Sequence – This book is downloadable from this week’s readings (see Module 4)

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Questions?

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